SSC CHSL 2020 Tier-I question paper with answers

11 August 2021 · Shift 3

66 questions as the Staff Selection Commission (SSC) printed them · answers from the official key · marking: +2 for a right answer, –0.50 for a wrong one

The other 34 of the paper's 100 questions are not reproduced: they need a figure or are printed as an image, or ask about formatting the source does not keep.

Try every question first: the answer key and the explanations follow the questions. Official answer-key notice: https://web.archive.org/web/20211105175401/https://ssc.nic.in/SSCFileServer/PortalManagement/UploadedFiles/FinalAnswerKeys_%20CHSLE2020_05112021.pdf

English Language 25 questions

Q.1

Select the incorrectly spelt word.

(A) irresistible
(B) illegitimate
(C) illegible
(D) irepairable

Q.2

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. My tailor is made some very stylish dresses for me as well as for my daughter.

(A) for my daughter
(B) is made
(C) very stylish dresses
(D) for me as well as

Q.3

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. A dime a dozen

(A) common and so of little value
(B) in great demand as not easily available
(C) available only in bulk
(D) not available everywhere

Q.4

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. someone who runs away from justice

(A) stowaway
(B) cheat
(C) fugitive
(D) thief

Q.5

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. The government has opened many new centres of excellence to train teachers in conducting online classes _____.

(A) effectively
(B) hopefully
(C) certainly
(D) automatically

Q.6

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options, select the one that gives their correct order. A. It is only after sunset that he satisfies his hunger and quenches his thirst. B. In this way, by practicing self-restraint for one month in a year, he is able to lead a life of self-discipline in all matters for the rest of the year. C. During the month of Ramzan, the believer abstains from food and drink in the daytime of his own free will. D. Fasting is an exercise in self-discipline and is good for everyone.

(A) DBCA
(B) CDAB
(C) CBDA
(D) DCAB

Q.7

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. PRECIOUS

(A) worthless
(B) plentiful
(C) ugly
(D) costly

Q.8

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. HAZARDOUS

(A) uncaring
(B) dangerous
(C) smooth
(D) predictable

Q.9

Select the most appropriate meaning of the given idiom. A red letter day

(A) a day of fun and enjoyment
(B) a day of horror
(C) the worst day
(D) a memorable day

Q.10

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'. It "was the biggest" jump in earnings for me and I was delighted.

(A) was the bigger
(B) is the big
(C) has been the biggest
(D) No substitution

Q.11

Select the most appropriate option to substitute the underlined segment in the given sentence. If there is no need to substitute it, select 'No substitution'. These days, wherever district courts are functioning, "hearings is limit" to urgent matters.

(A) hearings are limited
(B) hearing is limit
(C) No substitution
(D) hearings were limited

Q.12

Given below are four jumbled sentences. Out of the given options, select the one that gives their correct order. A. According to sources, one of the degrees will have to be in the regular mode and the other either in open and distance learning or online mode. B. In a move to improve students' career prospects, the University Grants Commission has approved the proposal to allow them to pursue two degree programmes at the same time. C. A committee formed under the UGC vice chairperson worked on the proposal based on feedback from the public. D. Once the guidelines are notified, a student studying in a university will be able to pursue another degree programme simultaneously.

(A) DBAC
(B) BCDA
(C) ABDC
(D) CBAD

Q.13

Select the INCORRECTLY spelt word.

(A) allert
(B) allegation
(C) alliteration
(D) almighty

Q.14

Select the most appropriate synonym of the given word. POLLUTE

(A) ridicule
(B) contaminate
(C) destroy
(D) condemn

Q.15

Select the correct passive form of the given sentence. The counsellor gave very good advice to the students.

(A) Very good advice to the students has been given by the counsellor.
(B) Very good advice to the students had been given by the counsellor.
(C) Very good advice is given to the students by the counsellor.
(D) Very good advice was given to the students by the counsellor.

Q.16

Select the correct indirect form of the given sentence. Mother said to me, “Enjoy your vacation with your friends.”

(A) Mother told me to enjoy my vacation with my friends.
(B) Mother asked me to enjoyed my vacation with my friends.
(C) Mother told me that you should enjoy your vacation with your friends.
(D) Mother told me that I will enjoy my vacation with my friends.

Q.17

In the given sentence, identify the segment which contains a grammatical error. The manager said that Rahul does not wants to go to Mumbai for the new project.

(A) does not wants
(B) for the new project
(C) said that
(D) to go to

Q.18

Select the most appropriate word to fill in the blank. The jail _____ have started yoga and meditation classes for the inmates.

(A) residents
(B) people
(C) workers
(D) authorities

Q.19

Select the most appropriate ANTONYM of the given word. Infallible

(A) Faulty
(B) Unfailing
(C) Dependable
(D) Reliable

Q.20

Select the word which means the same as the group of words given. A place where a dead person's body is burnt.

(A) crematorium
(B) graveyard
(C) basement
(D) dungeon

Q.21

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. As the full impact of cyclone Amphan’s fury emerged on Thursday morning and the count of uprooted trees (1) _____ the 5000 mark, environmentalists, horticulturists, and nature lovers mourned the huge (2) _____ . But they also felt that Kolkata could emerge stronger from the (3) _____ if it used the opportunity to move from arbitrary plantation drives to ones that (4) _____ more scientific and rational. The loss of trees is bound to have a great impact on the climate in (5) _____ parts of West Bengal as oxygen levels will go down.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 1.

(A) crossed
(B) crosses
(C) is crossing
(D) was crossed

Q.22

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. As the full impact of cyclone Amphan's fury emerged on Thursday morning and the count of uprooted trees (1) _____ the 5000 mark, environmentalists, horticulturists, and nature lovers mourned the huge (2) _____ . But they also felt that Kolkata could emerge stronger from the (3) _____ if it used the opportunity to move from arbitrary plantation drives to ones that (4) _____ more scientific and rational. The loss of trees is bound to have a great impact on the climate in (5) _____ parts of West Bengal as oxygen levels will go down.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 2.

(A) failure
(B) loss
(C) death
(D) passing

Q.23

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. As the full impact of cyclone Amphan's fury emerged on Thursday morning and the count of uprooted trees (1) _____ the 5000 mark, environmentalists, horticulturists, and nature lovers mourned the huge (2) _____ . But they also felt that Kolkata could emerge stronger from the (3) _____ if it used the opportunity to move from arbitrary plantation drives to ones that (4) _____ more scientific and rational. The loss of trees is bound to have a great impact on the climate in (5) _____ parts of West Bengal as oxygen levels will go down.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 3.

(A) construction
(B) destruction
(C) extinction
(D) creation

Q.24

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. As the full impact of cyclone Amphan's fury emerged on Thursday morning and the count of uprooted trees (1) _____ the 5000 mark, environmentalists, horticulturists, and nature lovers mourned the huge (2) _____ . But they also felt that Kolkata could emerge stronger from the (3) _____ if it used the opportunity to move from arbitrary plantation drives to ones that (4) _____ more scientific and rational. The loss of trees is bound to have a great impact on the climate in (5) _____ parts of West Bengal as oxygen levels will go down.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 4.

(A) have
(B) are
(C) was
(D) is

Q.25

In the following passage, some words have been deleted. Fill in the blanks with the help of the alternatives given. Select the most appropriate option for each blank. As the full impact of cyclone Amphan's fury emerged on Thursday morning and the count of uprooted trees (1) _____ the 5000 mark, environmentalists, horticulturists, and nature lovers mourned the huge (2) _____ . But they also felt that Kolkata could emerge stronger from the (3) _____ if it used the opportunity to move from arbitrary plantation drives to ones that (4) _____ more scientific and rational. The loss of trees is bound to have a great impact on the climate in (5) _____ parts of West Bengal as oxygen levels will go down.

Select the most appropriate option for blank No. 5.

(A) abundant
(B) much
(C) several
(D) differing

General Intelligence 17 questions

Q.1

Select the combination of letters that when sequentially placed in the blanks of the given letter series will complete the series. M T _ R M _ Q R _ V Q _ M W _ R M _ Q R

(A) R U M R Q Y
(B) Q U M Q R X
(C) Q U M R Q X
(D) Q U S R Q R

Q.2

Three of the following four letter-clusters are alike in a certain way and one is different. Select the odd one.

(A) PLSK
(B) DZHW
(C) GCKT
(D) HDLS

Q.3

In a code language, ORANGE is written as LKZGTX and MIRACLE is written as NBITXEV. How will LOCKDOWN be written in that language?

(A) OHXHWDGD
(B) OHDXHWDG
(C) OHXHWDDG
(D) OHXDWHDG

Q.4

Select the number that can replace the question mark (?) in the following series. 4, 11, 31, 65, 193, ?

(A) 396
(B) 369
(C) 389
(D) 398

Q.5

Pointing towards Kapil, Aditya said, "His father is the husband of my father's father's daughter". How is Aditya's father related to Kapil's mother?

(A) Father
(B) Husband
(C) Son
(D) Brother

Q.6

Select the correct combination of mathematical signs to sequentially replace the * signs to balance the given equation. 1496*8*13*40*5=0

(A) ÷, +, –, ×
(B) +, ÷, –, ×
(C) –, +, ÷, ×
(D) +, ÷, ×, –

Q.9

Which option represents the correct order of the given words as they would appear in English dictionary? 1. Rumoured 2. Rudiment 3. Rumanian 4. Royalties 5. Rigorous

(A) 4, 5, 2, 3, 1
(B) 4, 5, 2, 1, 3
(C) 5, 4, 2, 1, 3
(D) 5, 4, 2, 3, 1

Q.12

Two numbers, A and B, are such that the sum of 3% of A and 6% of B is four-fifth of the sum of 4% of A and 6% of B. Find the ratio of A + B and A – B?

(A) 4 : 5
(B) 6 : 5
(C) 7 : 5
(D) 5 : 6

Q.13

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (13, 37, 77)

(A) (15, 43, 83)
(B) (12, 38, 79)
(C) (14, 40, 83)
(D) (17, 53, 109)

Q.14

Three of the following four words are alike in a certain way and one is different. Select the odd one.

(A) Contention
(B) Turmoil
(C) Conflict
(D) Tranquility

Q.15

Select the set in which the numbers are related in the same way as are the numbers of the following set. (4, 140, 6)

(A) (9, 396, 4)
(B) (2, 121, 6)
(C) (5, 234, 7)
(D) (3, 269, 8)

Q.16

Select the word-pair that best represents a similar relationship to the one expressed in the given word-pair. Spanner : Grip

(A) Axe : Dig
(B) Tongs : Guard
(C) Auger : Bore
(D) Carve : Chisel

Q.17

Three of the following four number-pairs are alike in a certain way and one is different. Select the one that is different.

(A) 4 : 48
(B) 5 : 105
(C) 7 : 294
(D) 6 : 180

Q.18

'Awl' is related to 'Cobbler' and 'Chisel' is related to 'Sculptor' in the same way as 'Anvil' is related to '_____'.

(A) Carpenter
(B) Surgeon
(C) Butcher
(D) Blacksmith

Q.19

If STROKE is coded as 2317131089 and GLUTEN is coded as 1423871621, then how will CHARGE be coded as?

(A) 231220272052
(B) 232110270225
(C) 230211722025
(D) 232110272025

Q.22

Select the option that is related to the third letter-cluster in the same way as the second letter-cluster is related to the first letter-cluster. PRINT : TWRIP : : CLOSE : ?

(A) EQLNC
(B) EOKHC
(C) EQKNC
(D) EPLMC

Q.25

In the following question, the second number is related to the first number in some way, choose the alternative which is similarly related to the third number 13 : 196 : : 15 : ?

(A) 221
(B) 247
(C) 298
(D) 256

General Awareness 24 questions

Q.1

Which of the following is a replica of the famous Taj Mahal built in 1679?

(A) Zeenat-ul-Masjid
(B) Pari Mahal
(C) Bibi ka Maqbara
(D) Allahabad Mahal

Q.2
In which year was Jharkhand made a separate state of India?

(A) 1997
(B) 1999
(C) 2004
(D) 2000

Q.3
As on 2019, which is the largest multinational bank company in the world as measured by total assets?

(A) State Bank of India
(B) National Savings Bank
(C) Industrial and Commercial Bank of China
(D) Agricultural Bank of China

Q.4
Which Indian state is surrounded by Bangladesh on its north, west and south?

(A) Tripura
(B) Assam
(C) Mizoram
(D) West Bengal

Q.5
Which Indian journalist was awarded the Windham-Campbell Prize 2019 for the book 'Farthest Field: An Indian Story of the Second World War'?

(A) Ashok Malik
(B) Raghu Karnad
(C) Dionne Bunsha
(D) Mrinal Pande

Q.6
What was the theme for 11 February 2020, celebration of the United Nations International Day of Women and Girls in Science?

(A) Science for women empowerment
(B) Investment in Women and Girls in Science for Inclusive Green Growth
(C) Welcome the women and girl achievers in science
(D) Inclusive growth of women and girls in science

Q.7
'Bauhche' is a traditional bridegroom's sword worn during a tribal wedding ceremony in:

(A) Andhra Pradesh
(B) Uttar Pradesh
(C) Madhya Pradesh
(D) Arunachal Pradesh

Q.8
_____ was the first athlete to win an Olympic medal for Sri lanka.

(A) Parami Wasanthi Maristela
(B) Duncan White
(C) Greshan Dananjaya
(D) Susanthika Jayasinghe

Q.9
In which year did Nepal adopt its first democratic constitution?

(A) 2010
(B) 2015
(C) 2013
(D) 2017

Q.10
Mario de Miranda was a _____ from the state of Goa.

(A) designer
(B) vocalist
(C) cartoonist
(D) poet

Q.11
Which Indian sportsperson won a gold medal at the Para-badminton World Championship 2019?

(A) Deepa Malik
(B) Devendra Jhajharia
(C) Suhas Lalinakere Yathiraj
(D) Manasi Joshi

Q.12
Which one of the following is a rare disease caused by the deficiency of Vitamin D that causes the bones to become soft and to bend?

(A) Pernicious anemia
(B) Atrophic gastritis
(C) Lupus
(D) Rickets

Q.13
What is the other name for 'transistor computer'?

(A) First Generation Computer
(B) Third Generation Computer
(C) Second Generation Computer
(D) Fourth Generation Computer

Q.14
'Maimata' is a popular dance of the Kaloi community from the state of _____.

(A) Chattisgarh
(B) Odisha
(C) Tripura
(D) Assam

Q.15
Annu Rani is the first Indian woman to cross a distance of 60 m in _____ throw.

(A) javelin
(B) discus
(C) Shot put
(D) hammer

Q.16
The rivers Damodar, Brahmani and Kharkai originate from the state of _____ in India.

(A) Jharkhand
(B) Madhya Pradesh
(C) Chhattisgarh
(D) Haryana

Q.17
_____ glands release tears from our eyes.

(A) Thyroid
(B) Adrenal
(C) Pituitary
(D) Lacrimal

Q.18
In which year was the Bombay Stock Exchange established?

(A) 1864
(B) 1893
(C) 1875
(D) 1882

Q.19
In January 2020, _____ has secured a top position among the 115 aspirational districts that received grading on a system devised by the NITI Aayog.

(A) Sukma
(B) Jagdalpur
(C) Jashpur
(D) Gariaband

Q.20
Who created FORTRAN — the first high-level computer programming language?

(A) Dan Bricklin
(B) Marc Andreessen
(C) Larry Ellison
(D) John Backus

Q.21

In which year did the state of Himachal Pradesh come into existence?

(A) 1971
(B) 1947
(C) 1956
(D) 1965

Q.22

'Sandalwood' is the state tree of _____.

(A) Madhya Pradesh
(B) Karnataka
(C) Punjab
(D) Rajasthan

Q.24

Which Indian sportsperson won the 'World Games Athlete of the Year' award in January 2020?

(A) Rani Rampal
(B) Mary Kom
(C) PV Sindhu
(D) Koneru Humpy

Q.25

Which of the following is the largest dental tissue?

(A) Dentin
(B) Pulp
(C) Enamel
(D) Root

Answer key

English Language

Q.1 **(D)**	Q.2 **(B)**	Q.3 **(A)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(A)**	Q.6 **(D)**
Q.7 **(A)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(D)**	Q.10 **(D)**	Q.11 **(A)**	Q.12 **(B)**
Q.13 **(A)**	Q.14 **(B)**	Q.15 **(D)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(A)**	Q.18 **(D)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(A)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.23 **(B)**	Q.24 **(B)**
Q.25 **(C)**					

General Intelligence

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(A)**	Q.3 **(D)**	Q.4 **(C)**	Q.5 **(D)**	Q.6 **(A)**
Q.9 **(D)**	Q.12 **(C)**	Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(D)**	Q.15 **(C)**	Q.16 **(C)**
Q.17 **(B)**	Q.18 **(D)**	Q.19 **(D)**	Q.22 **(A)**	Q.25 **(D)**	

General Awareness

Q.1 **(C)**	Q.2 **(D)**	Q.3 **(C)**	Q.4 **(A)**	Q.5 **(B)**	Q.6 **(B)**
Q.7 **(D)**	Q.8 **(B)**	Q.9 **(B)**	Q.10 **(C)**	Q.11 **(D)**	Q.12 **(D)**
Q.13 **(C)**	Q.14 **(C)**	Q.15 **(A)**	Q.16 **(A)**	Q.17 **(D)**	Q.18 **(C)**
Q.19 **(A)**	Q.20 **(D)**	Q.21 **(A)**	Q.22 **(B)**	Q.24 **(A)**	Q.25 **(A)**

Explanations

English Language

Q.1 · Answer (D) irepairable

The correct spelling is 'irreparable'.

Q.2 · Answer (B) is made

The present perfect active needs 'has', not 'is': 'My tailor has made some very stylish dresses for me'.

Q.3 · Answer (A) common and so of little value

Something that is 'a dime a dozen' is so common that it has little value.

Q.4 · Answer (C) fugitive

A fugitive is someone who has run away, especially from the law. A stowaway hides on a ship or plane to travel free.

Q.5 · Answer (A) effectively

Teachers are trained to conduct online classes well, that is 'effectively'.

Q.6 · Answer (D) DCAB

D says that fasting is an exercise in self-discipline, C describes the Ramzan fast, A says when the fast is broken and B ('In this way') draws the conclusion: DCAB.

Q.7 · Answer (A) worthless

'Precious' means of great value; its opposite is 'worthless'.

Q.8 · Answer (B) dangerous

'Hazardous' means risky: 'dangerous'.

Q.9 · Answer (D) a memorable day

A 'red letter day' is a special, memorable day.

Q.10 · Answer (D) No substitution

The superlative 'the biggest' is right, and the past 'was' matches 'I was delighted', so no change is needed.

Q.11 · Answer (A) hearings are limited

The plural 'hearings' takes 'are', the passive needs the past participle 'limited', and 'These days' calls for the present tense.

Q.12 · Answer (B) BCDA

B gives the UGC's decision, C tells how the proposal was prepared, D says what students can do once the guidelines are notified and A adds the condition on the two modes: BCDA.

Q.13 · Answer (A) allert

The correct spelling is 'alert'.

Q.14 · Answer (B) contaminate

To 'pollute' is to make dirty or impure: to 'contaminate'.

Q.15 · Answer (D) Very good advice was given to the students by the counsellor.

The simple past 'gave' becomes 'was given' in the passive, with 'advice' as the subject.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Mother told me to enjoy my vacation with my friends.

An order is reported with 'told' and the infinitive, and 'your' becomes 'my': 'Mother told me to enjoy my vacation with my friends.'

Q.17 · Answer (A) does not wants

After 'does not' the verb takes its base form: 'does not want'.

Q.18 · Answer (D) authorities

Those in charge of a jail, who would start classes for its inmates, are its 'authorities'.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Faulty
'Infallible' means incapable of error; its opposite is 'faulty'.

Q.20 · Answer (A) crematorium
A crematorium is where the dead are burnt; a graveyard is where they are buried.

Q.21 · Answer (A) crossed
The past tense, like 'emerged' in the same sentence: the count of uprooted trees 'crossed' the 5000 mark.

Q.22 · Answer (B) loss
Nature lovers mourned the huge 'loss' of trees; 'death' and 'passing' are used of people.

Q.23 · Answer (B) destruction
Kolkata could emerge stronger from the 'destruction' the cyclone caused.

Q.24 · Answer (B) are
'Ones' stands for the plural 'plantation drives', so it takes 'are', not 'is' or 'was'; 'have' cannot be followed by the adjectives 'more scientific and rational'.

Q.25 · Answer (C) several
'Several' goes with a plural countable noun: 'several parts of West Bengal'. 'Much' and 'abundant' do not fit.

General Intelligence

Q.1 · Answer (C) Q U M R Q X
With Q, U, M, R, Q, X in the blanks the series reads MTQR MUQR MVQR MWQR MXQR: M, Q and R stay and the second letter runs T, U, V, W, X.

Q.2 · Answer (A) PLSK
In DZHW, GCKT and HDLS the letters move −4, then +8 (D → Z → H, G → C → K, H → D → L). In PLSK the second step is +7 (L → S), so it is the odd one.

Q.3 · Answer (D) OHXDWHDG
Letters in odd places are replaced by their opposites (A ↔ Z, B ↔ Y …) and letters in even places move 7 back: ORANGE → L K Z G T X. So LOCKDOWN → O H X D W H D G.

Q.4 · Answer (C) 389
The steps alternate between × 2 + 3 and × 3 − 2: 4 × 2 + 3 = 11, 11 × 3 − 2 = 31, 31 × 2 + 3 = 65, 65 × 3 − 2 = 193. Next, 193 × 2 + 3 = 389.

Q.5 · Answer (D) Brother
Aditya's father's father's daughter is his father's sister, and her husband is Kapil's father. So Kapil's mother is the sister of Aditya's father, who is therefore her brother.

Q.6 · Answer (A) ÷, +, −, ×
1496 ÷ 8 + 13 − 40 × 5 = 187 + 13 − 200 = 0.

Q.9 · Answer (D) 5, 4, 2, 3, 1
In dictionary order: Rigorous (5), Royalties (4), Rudiment (2), Rumanian (3), Rumoured (1). 'Rud' comes before 'Rum', and 'Ruma' before 'Rumo'.

Q.12 · Answer (C) 7 : 5
0.03A + 0.06B = (4/5)(0.04A + 0.06B) = 0.032A + 0.048B, so 0.012B = 0.002A and A = 6B. (A + B) : (A − B) = 7B : 5B = 7 : 5.

Q.13 · Answer (C) (14, 40, 83)
The second number is three times the first minus 2, and the third is twice the second plus 3: 13 × 3 − 2 = 37 and 37 × 2 + 3 = 77. Likewise 14 × 3 − 2 = 40 and 40 × 2 + 3 = 83.

Q.14 · Answer (D) Tranquility
Contention, turmoil and conflict all mean strife or disorder; tranquility means calm, so it is the odd one.

Q.15 · Answer (C) (5, 234, 7)
The middle number is half the sum of the cubes of the outer two: $(4^3 + 6^3)/2 = (64 + 216)/2 = 140$. Likewise $(5^3 + 7^3)/2 = (125 + 343)/2 = 234$.

Q.16 · Answer (C) Auger : Bore
A spanner is used to grip, as an auger is used to bore holes. In 'Carve : Chisel' the order is reversed, and an axe chops rather than digs.

Q.17 · Answer (B) 5 : 105
In 4 : 48, 7 : 294 and 6 : 180 the second number is the square of the first times one less than the first: $4^2 \times 3$, $7^2 \times 6$, $6^2 \times 5$. But $5^2 \times 4 = 100$, not 105, so 5 : 105 is the odd one.

Q.18 · Answer (D) Blacksmith
Each is a tool and the worker who uses it: a cobbler uses an awl, a sculptor a chisel and a blacksmith an anvil.

Q.19 · Answer (D) 232110272025
The letters are written in reverse order, each as 28 minus its place in the alphabet: STROKE → E K O R T S → 23 17 13 10 8 9. So CHARGE → E G R A H C → 23 21 10 27 20 25.

Q.22 · Answer (A) EQLNC
The first and last letters swap, the second moves 5 forward, the middle letter is replaced by its opposite (I ↔ R) and the fourth moves 5 back: PRINT → T W R I P. So CLOSE → E Q L N C.

Q.25 · Answer (D) 256
The second number is the square of one more than the first: $(13 + 1)^2 = 196$. Likewise $(15 + 1)^2 = 256$.

General Awareness

Q.1 · Answer (C) Bibi ka Maqbara
Bibi Ka Maqbara in Aurangabad, the tomb of Aurangzeb's wife Dilras Banu Begum, is modelled on the Taj Mahal and is known as the 'Taj of the Deccan'.

Q.2 · Answer (D) 2000
Jharkhand was carved out of Bihar on 15 November 2000.

Q.3 · Answer (C) Industrial and Commercial Bank of China
The Industrial and Commercial Bank of China (ICBC) was the world's largest bank by total assets in 2019.

Q.4 · Answer (A) Tripura
Tripura is bordered by Bangladesh on the north, west and south; only on the east does it meet Assam and Mizoram.

Q.5 · Answer (B) Raghu Karnad
Raghu Karnad won a 2019 Windham-Campbell Prize in non-fiction for 'Farthest Field'.

Q.6 · Answer (B) Investment in Women and Girls in Science for Inclusive Green Growth
SSC's key gives 'Investment in Women and Girls in Science for Inclusive Green Growth', the theme many sources reported for 2020. Strictly, that was the 2019 theme: the 2020 UN assembly's was 'Investment in Equality in Science, Technology and Innovation in the Digitalization Era for Inclusive Green Growth', to which the key's option is the nearest.

Q.7 · Answer (D) Arunachal Pradesh
SSC's key gives Arunachal Pradesh, where the bridegroom's 'Bauhche' sword is one of the accessories worn at a tribal wedding.

Q.8 · Answer (B) Duncan White
Duncan White won silver in the 400 m hurdles at the 1948 London Olympics, the first Olympic medal for Ceylon (now Sri Lanka).

Q.9 · Answer (B) 2015
SSC's key gives 2015, which fits either reading of the year. Nepal's first democratic constitution, granted by King Mahendra in 1959, is the Constitution of 2015 in Nepal's own Bikram Sambat calendar; and on 20 September 2015 Nepal adopted its present constitution, the first drawn up by an elected Constituent Assembly. None of the other years listed brought a constitution.

Q.10 · Answer (C) cartoonist
Mario de Miranda, from Goa, was one of India's best-known cartoonists and illustrators.

Q.11 · Answer (D) Manasi Joshi
Manasi Joshi won the women's singles SL3 gold at the 2019 BWF Para-Badminton World Championships in Basel.

Q.12 · Answer (D) Rickets
Rickets, caused by a lack of vitamin D (which the body needs to absorb calcium), softens children's bones so that they bend. Pernicious anaemia comes from a lack of vitamin B12.

Q.13 · Answer (C) Second Generation Computer
Second-generation computers used transistors in place of the vacuum tubes of the first generation; integrated circuits came with the third.

Q.14 · Answer (C) Tripura
SSC's key gives Tripura: 'Maimata' is the Mamita dance, which Tripura's Tripuri people perform at their harvest festival.

Q.15 · Answer (A) javelin
Annu Rani, India's national record holder in the women's javelin, was the first Indian woman to throw it beyond 60 m.

Q.16 · Answer (A) Jharkhand
SSC's key gives Jharkhand. The Damodar rises on the Chota Nagpur plateau in Jharkhand, and the South Koel and the Sankh, which meet near Rourkela to form the Brahmani, also rise there. The Kharkai rises in the Simlipal hills of Odisha's Mayurbhanj district, but flows through Jharkhand to join the Subarnarekha at Jamshedpur.

Q.17 · Answer (D) Lacrimal
The lacrimal glands, above the outer corner of each eye, produce tears.

Q.18 · Answer (C) 1875
The Bombay Stock Exchange, Asia's oldest, was founded in 1875 as the Native Share and Stock Brokers' Association.

Q.19 · Answer (A) Sukma
Sukma, a Maoist-affected district of Bastar in southern Chhattisgarh, came top of NITI Aayog's delta ranking of the 115 aspirational districts released at the end of 2019.

Q.20 · Answer (D) John Backus
John Backus led the IBM team that created FORTRAN in the 1950s. Dan Bricklin co-created VisiCalc, Marc Andreessen the Mosaic browser, and Larry Ellison co-founded Oracle.

Q.21 · Answer (A) 1971
Himachal Pradesh, a Union Territory from 1956, became a full state on 25 January 1971.

Q.22 · Answer (B) Karnataka
Sandalwood, for which Mysuru is famous, is Karnataka's state tree.

Q.24 · Answer (A) Rani Rampal
Rani Rampal, captain of India's women's hockey team, was voted World Games Athlete of the Year for 2019, announced in January 2020: the first hockey player to win it.

Q.25 · Answer (A) Dentin

Dentin forms the bulk of a tooth, beneath the enamel of the crown and the cementum of the root. Enamel is the hardest tissue but only a thin outer layer.

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